IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 32

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Sedgewick	
2	47	
3	1:2500	
4	colour target	
5	scholarly article	
6	secure download	
7	B	
8	C	
9	A	
10	A	
11	B	
12	E	
13	H	
14	C	
15	F	
16	A	
17	D	
18	B	
19	E	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	C	
21	B	
22	A	
23	C	
24	B	
25	C	
26	wall thickness	
27	fuel mass	
28	wind direction	
29	witness tiles	
30	fracture pattern	
31	tension	
32	embolism	
33	pit membranes	
34	stomata	
35	carbon dioxide	
36	safety margins	
37	rooting depth	
38	midday	
39	water transport	
40	new growth	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Cormac Ellery	County Map Archive, Cormac speaking.
Livia Sedgewick	Hello. My surname is Sedgewick, S-E-D-G-E-W-I-C-K. I need a scan for a research article.
Cormac Ellery	Certainly. Which map have you identified?
Livia Sedgewick	Sheet 47 in the coastal survey series. The catalogue also lists a sheet 74, but that covers the neighbouring district. I found the reference through your online catalogue, but the thumbnail was too small to check handwritten revisions.

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Cormac Ellery	The scan will show them. We capture the entire sheet first and can supply a second cropped view for the article, provided the crop does not remove the map's identifying margin.
Cormac Ellery	The paper sheet exists at two scales. Is your reference the town plan?
Livia Sedgewick	No, it is the wider survey at one to two thousand five hundred, written 1:2500.
Cormac Ellery	Good. For a publication scan we place a colour target beside the map before capture, so later readers can judge whether the digital colour is faithful. Scale is easy to mistype, so the order form will display it both as a ratio and in words. The colour target is removed from the publication crop only after colour correction; the preservation master keeps it visible. That way, any later adjustment can be traced back to a documented capture.
Cormac Ellery	What will the image be used for?
Livia Sedgewick	A scholarly article on shoreline change, not a commercial guidebook.
Cormac Ellery	That distinction matters for the permission record. We will prepare the full-resolution file as a secure download; it is too large for an email attachment, and the download link expires after fourteen days. A secure link also allows us to send the uncompressed preservation derivative. Please download it on a computer rather than opening it in a phone preview, which may create a reduced copy. We keep the link active for two weeks and can issue it again after identity verification if necessary.
Livia Sedgewick	Does the archive own copyright because it owns the map?
Cormac Ellery	Not necessarily. We check rights status separately to determine whether the scan may be republished. Ownership of the paper object does not automatically include publication rights. We can scan first, but we will not issue the publication licence until that check is complete. The rights researcher checks the survey's date, creator and any later annotations separately. Different elements on one sheet may have different legal histories. If a note was added much later, permission for the base map does not automatically settle permission for that annotation.
Livia Sedgewick	Please keep all the marginal notes visible, including the survey date and scale bar.
Cormac Ellery	We will. The crop can include the map's annotations and scale information without showing the conservation cradle. For your named article, the appropriate licence is the scholarly-publication licence. It covers this single use and requires the archive credit supplied with the download. Your article can reproduce one map image in print and the corresponding online edition. A book cover, exhibition panel or commercial database would require a new request. Please keep the credit line with the image file so an editor does not replace it with a generic acknowledgement during layout.
Cormac Ellery	I'll send a proof image before final release. Check the sheet number, orientation and crop, but do not judge fine colour from the proof because it is compressed for quick viewing. Once you approve those structural details, the archive will generate the full file and attach a metadata record describing capture date, equipment and any digital adjustments.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

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Petra Wynne	Welcome to Northport’s rebuilt bus interchange. Station Road runs along the southern edge of your plan. The signal crossing is at B, where the tactile path enters the forecourt. Ignore the crossing by the taxi exit: it has no pedestrian phase and is shown only as a service boundary.
Petra Wynne	After crossing, follow the covered walkway north-east. The mobility desk is E, immediately beside the lift and opposite the ticket machines. Staff there arrange boarding assistance and provide wheelchairs; they do not change tickets or reserve seats.
Petra Wynne	Passengers needing a low-stimulation space can use the quiet waiting room at H. It has adjustable lighting, solid doors and no public-address speaker, although departure information appears on a visual screen and an emergency light flashes if evacuation is required.
Petra Wynne	The taxi rank is C, beyond the eastern service road. Taxis enter and leave without crossing the bus apron. Join the signed queue rather than approaching a vehicle from behind; the walking route is slightly longer but keeps passengers away from reversing buses.
Petra Wynne	For routes and fares, use the information point at F, farther north than the mobility desk. If you have booked assistance, report to the mobility desk first, but take fare changes and operator questions to the information point.
Petra Wynne	The sheltered link between the old and new buildings is A on the western side. It is not the glass corridor beside Bay 6. Cyclists must dismount in the forecourt and leave bicycles at the western racks, because bicycles cannot be taken through the link.
Petra Wynne	Now look at the departure bays. The coastal service leaves from Bay 4, option D. That bay remains fixed throughout the day, including during rail engineering work.
Petra Wynne	The airport coach uses Bay 2, option B. Roadworks can delay the journey, so passengers should allow extra time, but the departure point does not change.
Petra Wynne	The evening local departs from Bay 5, option E. Check the main screen because its destination is sometimes announced without the route number.
Petra Wynne	Replacement buses for disrupted trains use Bay 3, option C. It has room for luggage and rail staff. Those vehicles may display a rail destination rather than a bus number, and staff check tickets at the head of the bay.
Petra Wynne	Screens at every bay show destination, operator and expected departure. If an announcement and a screen appear to conflict, ask staff instead of following the largest queue. The new layout is designed to keep pedestrians apart from reversing vehicles while maintaining direct step-free access to every passenger facility.
Petra Wynne	The concourse remains staffed until eight in the evening. After that, the help button connects to the control room. Please keep the tactile route clear, especially where it crosses the shallow drainage channel near the signal crossing.
Petra Wynne	If you arrive during the morning peak, pause beyond the crossing rather than stopping on the tactile paving. A marshal may hold pedestrians briefly while a bus turns, but the signal sequence itself does not change. Live departure screens are repeated inside the quiet room in visual form, so passengers using that space do not need to return to the noisy concourse simply to check a time.

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Petra Wynne	Luggage trolleys must remain on the eastern half of the forecourt, where the surface is level. They are not permitted in the sheltered link because that passage also serves as an evacuation route. Lost property is handled at the information point during staffed hours and through the control-room button later. These arrangements may appear detailed, but they prevent the different assistance, ticketing and safety functions from becoming confused. Large-print plans can be collected free from either staffed counter on request.

Part 3 - educational/training discussion

Mae Solway	For a fair comparison, every vessel needs the same dimensions. A larger pot heats and cools differently, so size would otherwise confound the effect of the temper.
Dorian Kells	We can use moulds for the rim diameter and height, then measure again after drying because the mixtures may shrink differently.
Mae Solway	What should count as the control group?
Dorian Kells	Pots made from the same clay but with no added temper. They must receive the same mixing, drying, handling and firing schedule as the experimental pots.
Mae Solway	If a pot seems too close to the hottest zone once the fire is burning, should we move it?
Dorian Kells	No. Movement would introduce uncontrolled temperature variation and might cause damage itself. We'll randomise positions before ignition and record the layout on a scaled sketch.
Mae Solway	Would a second firing the following weekend give us replication?
Dorian Kells	Not reliable replication. Weather and fuel conditions could not be held constant, so a second day might add a new confound. It could be analysed as a separate experiment, but not casually merged with this one.
Mae Solway	Then the main improvement over our first design is to place witness tiles around the firing area. They provide spatial evidence without disturbing the pots.
Dorian Kells	For the measurement sheet, keep wall thickness similar. Thick walls may survive because they warm more slowly, not because a temper recipe is better.
Mae Solway	Any vessel outside the agreed thickness or size tolerance should be recorded and excluded before the firing rather than moved to a smaller group.
Dorian Kells	We'll also record the fuel mass before firing. A weighed amount is more defensible than saying that each wood pile looked roughly equal.
Mae Solway	During the firing, one person will log wind direction at fixed intervals. Changes in airflow can alter oxygen supply and push heat across the firing area.
Dorian Kells	Humidity will be measured once before ignition as background context, not entered in the repeated firing log. That keeps the requested series unambiguous.
Mae Solway	The witness tiles should go at measured distances and orientations around the fire. Their colour and surface changes will give us a rough map of heat exposure between the three temperature sensors.
Dorian Kells	After cooling, classify vessel damage by fracture pattern rather than simply calling pots broken or unbroken. Photograph fragments in place and record where each crack began.
Mae Solway	Each pot will receive a code that hides its temper recipe from the person scoring cracks. Obvious colour differences may remain, but blinding can still reduce selective attention.

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Dorian Kells	We should define the fracture categories before firing and practise them on discarded examples. The report must include excluded pots and missing measurements, not only successful specimens.
Mae Solway	Photographs, logs and sensor files also need synchronised times. Then a sudden wind change or fuel addition can be compared with later damage without relying on memory.
Dorian Kells	Finally, reserve clay for chemical and microscopic work. Specimens must be selected by a written rule rather than because they look dramatic; otherwise unusual damage could dominate the conclusion.
Mae Solway	For each vessel, the record should link the recipe, dimensions, coded position and photograph without revealing the recipe to the first damage scorer. A second researcher can unlock the codes only after the initial classifications are frozen.
Dorian Kells	We also need a rule for missing data. If a sensor fails, we should flag that interval rather than infer a temperature from nearby readings. The witness tiles offer spatial context, but they are not calibrated thermometers and should not be presented as substitutes.
Mae Solway	When the fire is fully cold, fragments from each pot will go onto a separate tray before transport. Mixing pieces from neighbouring vessels would destroy the connection between a fracture and its firing position.
Dorian Kells	The final comparison will therefore combine survival, crack origin, deformation and surface change. One recipe may reduce catastrophic breakage yet produce severe warping, so ranking pots by a single outcome would conceal an important trade-off. We will present the coded observations before interpreting recipes, keep the raw photographs alongside the scoring table, and ask a second scorer to classify a sample independently. Agreement will show whether the categories are usable; disagreement will be resolved by revisiting the written criteria rather than by choosing the more convenient outcome.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Lecturer	Water in a tall tree travels through narrow xylem conduits under tension. Evaporation from leaves pulls on a continuous water column, rather like drawing liquid through an extremely fine system of pipes. This mechanism is effective, but it leaves the column vulnerable when soil dries and the tension becomes unusually strong. The cohesion of water molecules helps transmit that pull down the continuous column. Because the pressure is negative, a tiny air entry can expand rather than collapse. The architecture of conduits therefore reflects a compromise between moving large quantities efficiently and limiting the consequences of failure.
Lecturer	If air enters a conduit, it forms an embolism and blocks transport through that route. Air does not necessarily spread through the whole stem, because pit membranes between neighbouring conduits can slow or stop it. Their pores permit water movement while providing a partial barrier to expanding air bubbles. Wide conduits usually transport water efficiently, but an embolism in one wide route can remove substantial capacity. Networks with many narrower conduits may retain alternative paths. Neither design is universally superior; performance depends on climate, plant form and the cost of constructing and maintaining tissue.

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Lecturer	Plants can reduce water loss by closing stomata. The trade-off is that closure also restricts carbon dioxide uptake and therefore photosynthesis. Species manage that tension differently. Some tolerate narrow operating ranges; others maintain wider safety margins between everyday water stress and the point where transport failure becomes likely. Stomatal closure can happen within minutes, whereas roots and wood change over much longer periods. Short-term regulation buys time but also slows carbon gain. Repeated drought may therefore affect growth even when a plant avoids immediate hydraulic failure.
Lecturer	Access to deep water often depends on rooting depth, yet roots are only part of the story. Measurements made at midday may mislead if they capture a temporary peak in stress rather than the plant's daily recovery. Researchers therefore compare several times and link leaf measurements with stem conductivity and soil moisture. Predawn measurements are sometimes used to estimate recovery after a cool night, while midday values capture peak atmospheric demand. Comparing them reveals whether stress is transient. A single midday reading cannot show whether transport rebounds by evening or remains impaired across several days.
Lecturer	Repair strategies vary. In some plants, nearby living cells help refill or isolate damaged conduits; in others, blocked tissue remains unusable. Woody species may replace lost capacity through new growth in a later season. Survival therefore depends on keeping enough water transport functional while balancing conservation against continued carbon gain. New xylem is costly and arrives only as the plant grows. If drought recurs before replacement is complete, accumulated damage can reduce resilience. Ecologists therefore monitor survival, growth and conductivity together; green leaves alone do not prove that the transport network is intact.
Lecturer	This framework helps explain why drought mortality is rarely caused by one threshold in isolation. Hydraulic failure interacts with depleted carbon reserves, heat damage, pests and the timing of rain. A shower may wet leaves without restoring deep soil moisture, while an intense storm can run off before roots gain access. Researchers use vulnerability curves to estimate how conductivity declines as tension increases, then compare those curves with pressures measured in the field. Methods themselves can introduce artefacts, particularly when long conduits are cut or samples dehydrate during handling, so protocols and species anatomy must be reported. At landscape scale, variation among individuals matters too: age, previous drought and local soil depth can produce different outcomes within one stand. Models become more useful when they represent that diversity instead of assigning every tree a single average response. The practical conclusion is that maintaining transport, carbon gain and recovery capacity are linked challenges, and no one measurement can summarise them all.
Lecturer	Remote sensing extends this work from stems to landscapes. Thermal cameras can identify unusually warm crowns, which may indicate reduced transpiration, while repeated spectral observations reveal changes in leaf pigments and canopy cover. These signals are valuable for locating stress but are not direct measurements of embolism. Ground measurements remain necessary to separate hydraulic damage from disease, leaf loss or differences in sun exposure. Long-term plots are especially informative because they connect a drought event with recovery in later seasons. Some trees restore leaf area quickly while their growth remains depressed; others lose branches yet maintain transport through surviving tissue. By tracking weather, soil moisture, conductivity and growth together, researchers can test which combinations precede mortality and which indicate resilience. This evidence is increasingly used to select monitoring sites and evaluate whether management actions, such as reducing competition for water, actually improve recovery rather than merely changing appearance in the short term.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	keyboard	
2	matrices	
3	assembler	
4	casting station	
5	spacebands	
6	distribution channel	
7	II	
8	V	
9	I	
10	VI	
11	III	
12	VII	
13	IV	
14	TRUE	
15	FALSE	
16	FALSE	
17	TRUE	
18	FALSE	
19	TRUE	
20	NOT GIVEN	
21	history	site history
22	targeted sampling	
23	raised beds	
24	exposure routes	
25	professional assessment	
26	transparent report	
27	YES	
28	NO	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	NOT GIVEN	
30	YES	
31	NO	
32	B	
33	C	
34	A	
35	D	
36	B	
37	C	
38	A	
39	D	
40	B	

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